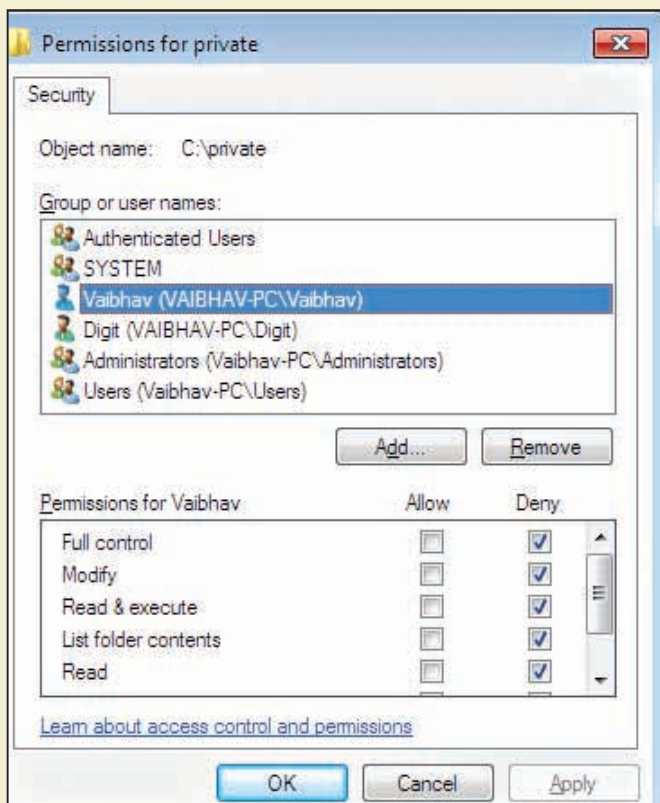




Changing security settings of an NTFS folder

On the start menu search box, type "certmgr.msc" and hit enter. On the new certificate manager window that opens up, expand the 'personal' folder on the left pane and then open the 'certificates' folder. You will find your certificate resting there. Double click it to open the certificate properties. On the 'details' tab, click the 'copy to file' button and you are ready to export your keys.

In fact, this method would also save you when you have just accidentally deleted the only copy of the file which had the keys in it. If you are wondering on how to import the keys from the exported PFX file, here is the majestic *modus operandi*: double click the file!

## Using permissions to prevent unwanted eyes

If you have ever cared to trouble the Google servers hunting for a freeware which you suppose would help you defend your

folders and would have found everything from spywares and Trojans to sharewares and expensive but difficult to use programs, you will love the way NTFS does it for free. To protect a folder, right click and open the folder properties. Go to security tab and click on the 'edit' button. Now you can decide on which permissions you want for which user. You can opt for different permissions for different users.

If a user is not listed currently, you can add him in the list by using the 'Add' button. Bear in mind, gentlemen, that if you are a user with a limited account, or there is another administrator on the system, he will be able to edit the permissions according to his fancies.

## Preventing other users from launching a program

Protecting a folder sometimes is not as essential as preventing other users from running a

program. This might be the case when the program you use is sensitive to be opened such an enterprise class program which is also installed on your laptop for your ease. Parental controls too can be enforced using this deception.

All you need to do is to open the security properties of an executable file and 'deny' the 'Read & Execute' permissions on that file for the users whom you do not want to run the program. Normal users cannot change the permissions unless they are exclusively allowed for it but again, another administrator will be able to revert back the settings if he wishes to.

## Registry Registry too has permissions

As strange as it might sound, Registry too has permissions. You can create a new key and more keys and name-value pairs in the registry to your benefit. Although it is not the best place to hide secrets, there are no limits to innovations! Remember though that you should not use this feature to

## Disable Compression on your system

Although NTFS serves with two great and useful features of Encryption and Compression on your system, they have their own hitches. Compression needs time. Whenever you open a compressed file, decompression has to be done. When you make changes to such a file, the contents or the changes are to be compressed again. In some situations (such as a video editing environment), this has to be avoided at all costs.

You can ask Windows to disable NTFS compression feature. For this, you need to open the registry editor (type `regedit` on the start search, hit Enter and say 'yes' to UAC prompt) and navigate to the following location on the left pane: `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\FileSystem`. On the right pane find the key named 'NtfsDisableCompression'. Now, double click it to edit the value and enter '1' (without quotes) in the value data field.



Compression disabled via Registry

alter permissions on any key you like. It may cost you a complete system reinstall! But you can surely keep treasured some of your little nifty secrets somewhere deep down the registry and lock it so that others do not discover it. To use this feature, simply right click a key and select 'permissions...'

Upon restart, your machine will no more have the forte to compress files. Not to worry though. The files which are already compressed will continue to behave normal but no new files will be fortunate enough to be compressed anymore. Even those which were compressed before cannot be